

THE WALL STREET JOURNAL.

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★★★★ \$5.00

DJIA 43239.50 ▼ 193.62 0.45%

NASDAQ 18544.42 ▼ 2.8%

STOXX 600 557.11 ▼ 0.5%

10-YR. TREAS. ▼ 10/32, yield 4.284%

OIL \$70.35 ▲ \$1.73

GOLD \$2,883.20 ▼ \$34.60

EURO \$1.0399

YEN 149.82

What's News

Business & Finance

◆ **Amazon's cloud-computing business** unveiled its first quantum-computing chip, which it said was a step in the development of useful, reliable quantum computers. **B1**

◆ **Microsoft called on the Trump administration** to overhaul a system of curbs on the sale of cutting-edge U.S. artificial-intelligence chips to friendly nations. **B1**

◆ **U.S. stocks fell** as investors tried to digest Trump's new tariff threats and federal spending cuts. The S&P 500, Nasdaq and Dow slid 1.6%, 2.8% and 0.5%, respectively. **B1**

◆ **A gauge of the number of homes** going under contract in the U.S. fell to its lowest level on record in January amid high prices and mortgage rates. **A2**

◆ **Meta apologized for** what it said was an error that led to graphic and violent videos flooding the feeds of a vast number of Instagram users, including minors. **B1**

◆ **NFL teams gathered** detailed consumer data, including geolocation, without clear disclosures and opt-outs, failing to meet standards set by the Digital Advertising Alliance. **B1**

◆ **HP said it would lay off** up to 2,000 more employees as part of a cost-cutting plan, bringing the total number of job reductions to as many as 9,000. **B4**

◆ **The Agnelli family's** holding company said it would sell part of its stake in Ferrari to raise billions of dollars to pursue an acquisition and buy back shares. **B3**

◆ **7-Eleven owner's** founding family failed to get financing for a proposed management buyout that could have derailed a foreign takeover attempt. **B2**

World-Wide

◆ **Trump struck a more** supportive tone on Ukraine during his meetings with U.K. Prime Minister Starmer, but stopped short of promising the security guarantees for Kyiv that European allies want. **A1, A6**

◆ **The U.S. intends next** week to impose an additional 10% tariff on China and proceed with 25% tariffs on products from Canada and Mexico, Trump said. **A1**

◆ **Mexico extradited** to the U.S. Rafael Caro Quintero, a drug boss wanted for the 1985 killing of a DEA agent, delivering on a long-standing U.S. demand. **A3**

◆ **Trump administration** officials moved to drop a CFPB lawsuit that accused Capital One of misleading customers over the interest rates on their savings accounts. **A4**

◆ **Andrew Tate**, under investigation for human trafficking in Romania, arrived in the U.S. after a Trump official discussed the case with Bucharest. **A5**

◆ **Imprisoned Kurdish** militant leader Abdullah Öcalan urged his followers to disarm after decades of violence that destabilized Turkey and the wider Middle East. **A6**

◆ **Three Austrian** mainstream parties said they would form a government, elbowing aside a far-right group that doubled its share of the vote in an election five months earlier. **A8**

◆ **An illness linked** to bats has killed scores of people in the Democratic Republic of Congo, with nearly half dying within 48 hours of showing symptoms. **A8**

◆ **Died: Gene Hackman**, 95, storied American actor. **A3, A10**

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As Measles Spreads, Vaccination Push Is On



OUCH: Devonay Pena comforts her daughter, Jaqi Herrera, after the 13-month-old received her first dose of the MMR vaccine Thursday in Lubbock, Texas. A measles outbreak in West Texas has sickened scores of people and one child has died.

Trump Softens His Tone on Kyiv But Won't Give Security Pledge

President, meeting U.K.'s leader, says he has confidence in Russia making peace

WASHINGTON—President Trump struck a more supportive tone on Ukraine during his meetings with U.K. Prime Minister Keir Starmer on Thursday, but stopped short of promising the security guarantees for Kyiv that European allies want.

Starmer raised a plan to send European peacekeepers to Ukraine, seeking a U.S. military “backstop” of air defenses and intelligence support. Trump repeatedly said he would only consider those options after a cease-fire is reached between Moscow and Kyiv, an agreement he said he expects President Vladimir Putin of Russia to honor.

“I have confidence, if we make a deal, it's going to hold,” he said in the Oval Office, adding that his approach

By Alexander Ward, Natalie Andrews and Siobhan Hughes

would be “trust and verify.” Trump also tempered some of his harshest criticisms of Ukraine. Asked if he still thought President Volodymyr Zelensky of Ukraine was a “dictator,” Trump said: “Did I say that? I can't believe I said that.” He also vowed to help Kyiv reclaim as much seized territory from Russia as possible.

That could lower the tensions ahead of a high-stakes meeting with Zelensky on Friday, the fourth European leader in a week to meet with Trump about trans-Atlantic security and Russia's invasion. “We're going to get along really well. I have a lot of respect for him,” Trump said of Zelensky.

If Starmer failed to rope the U.S. into a peacekeeping

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◆ **Ukraine rattled as U.S. eyes 2022 plan.....** A6

Ill-Prepared North Korean Soldiers Describe Chaos Before Ukraine Capture

Two North Korean soldiers captured by Ukraine knew nothing about the war they were sent to fight. They were

By Matthew Luxmoore in Kyiv, Ukraine, and Dasl Yoon in Seoul

handed Kalashnikov rifles and told they would be facing off against South Koreans who were aiding Ukraine.

Days later, they were fighting Ukrainians on the front lines in Russia's Kursk region, they said.

They were instructed to evade capture at all costs—by blowing themselves up if they had to. That message was reinforced by North Korean secret police who conducted ideological sessions on the ground in Russia, stressing that surrender was tanta-

mount to treason.

The indoctrination didn't stop even under Ukrainian artillery fire. Military commanders read a letter from North Korean leader Kim Jong Un, which some soldiers were told to transcribe by hand. “I really miss you comrades,” Kim said in the New Year's greeting.

In interviews, the two North Koreans captured by Ukraine offered the most detailed pic-

tures yet of how young soldiers dispatched by Kim's regime to aid Russia are experiencing the war. The Wall Street Journal was the first Western outlet to speak with the men, who are being held at a facility in the Ukrainian capital, Kyiv.

Their accounts of the arc of their lives—from leaving home as militarized teenagers steeped in Kim's personality cult to be-

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U.S. Vows To Raise Tariffs On Three Countries

Trump plans higher levies on China and ending a reprieve for Canada, Mexico

By Gavin Bade and Lingling Wei

WASHINGTON—The U.S. plans next week to impose an additional 10% tariff on imports from China over its role in the fentanyl trade and move forward with 25% tariffs on products from Canada and Mexico, President Trump said Thursday, setting up a pivotal week for his protectionist trade agenda.

The China move, slated to take effect Tuesday along with the Canada and Mexico actions, doubles up on the previous 10% additional tariff Trump placed on Chinese products this month.

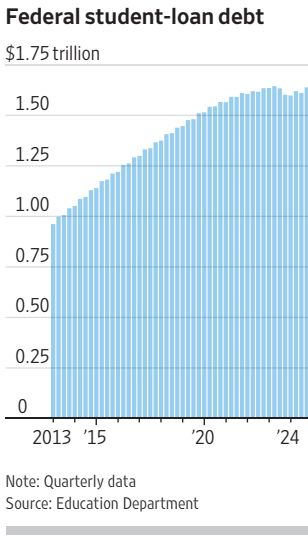
In a post Thursday on his Truth Social platform, Trump reinforced his threat to impose 25% tariffs on products from Canada and Mexico. Later in the Oval Office, he said the U.S.'s neighbors hadn't done enough to curb drug smuggling to win another delay for those duties.

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◆ **Trump's tariff threats hit S&P 500, Nasdaq.....** B1

Student Debt Pain Grows

Borrowers who haven't yet resumed their student-loan payments are taking hits as their credit scores suffer. **A3**



Nvidia Adapted Its Chips To Keep AI Lead

By ASA FITCH

Nvidia faced a growing threat early last year: The artificial-intelligence world was shifting in a way that invited competition.

As millions of people started using AI tools, operating the underlying models to respond to their many queries became more important than the computing-intensive work of training them—which propelled Nvidia to the top of the AI boom. Many expected that shift could give competitors, including Advanced Micro Devices, an opening to pry away market share.

But Nvidia was already preparing to adapt and stay at the forefront of the AI race despite the shift away from creating models and toward operating

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◆ **Heard on the Street: Nvidia has more road to run.....** B10

Hackman's Death Probed



SCREEN LEGEND: Two-time Oscar winner Gene Hackman, 95, shown in 1971's 'The French Connection,' and his wife, Betsy Arakawa, 64, were found dead in a New Mexico home. **A3, A10**

Becoming a Beer Sommelier Is Tough. Explaining It Is Harder.

Exclusive club of Master Cicerones

finds title comes with perks and questions

By Kristina Peterson and Laura Cooper

Jason Pratt was working in a grad school laboratory doing microbiology research at Michigan State University when he decided to leave academia for beer.

His parents were surprised. Although the post at Miller Brewing in Milwaukee involved science, his primary qualification when it came to beer was knowing where to find the cheapest pitcher.

Now Pratt is part of one of

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The 'Spy Sheikh' Taking the AI World by Storm

Abu Dhabi royal has more than \$1.5 trillion to spend and he's in a hurry

By Eliot Brown and Berber Jin

The Abu Dhabi royal sometimes called “the spy sheikh” is accustomed to using his vast wealth to master his many obsessions, which have ranged over the years from martial arts to chess to videogames.

Now Sheikh Tahnoon bin Zayed Al Nahyan, the United Arab Emirates' national security adviser and brother of the president, is deploying a similar playbook at a much grander scale. He wants to muscle his tiny emirate to the front of the race to develop and control AI systems that could transform the global economy.

The world is taking notice. The CEOs of Apple, Microsoft and BlackRock have all paid homage at his elaborate Persian Gulf royal com-

pound in recent months. On a fall trip to the U.S., he grappled with fellow Brazilian jujitsu devotee Mark Zuckerberg, and donned a sweatshirt and jeans for a visit with Elon Musk at Tesla's Texas factory.

All of this is possible in part because the 56-year-old Tahnoon controls more money than almost anyone on the planet, as the chairman of two Abu Dhabi wealth funds with an estimated \$1.4 trillion in assets and the steward of an enormous personal fortune.

A new artificial intelligence fund he leads, MGX, is set to be infused with more than \$50 billion from his wealth and other Abu Dhabi sources, according to people familiar with the fund. Billions of dollars more are set to be spent on AI by Group

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